

Thai Acuna

IT Support Specialist | Systems & Home Lab

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT Support Specialist with 4+ years of Tier 1/Tier 2 experience supporting end users across Windows, Active Directory, Microsoft 365, and Intune. Builds and runs a multi-node home lab (Docker, reverse proxy, DNS filtering, zero-trust access) to practice systems administration. Seeking a Systems Administrator or advanced IT support role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Identity & Endpoint: Active Directory, Microsoft 365 / Office 365 admin, Microsoft Intune, user provisioning, permissions and access management

Support & ITSM: Tier 1/Tier 2 troubleshooting, ServiceNow, knowledge base documentation, remote support, Windows desktop/laptop/printer setup

Infrastructure: Docker, Portainer, WSL2, Nginx Proxy Manager (reverse proxy), Linux (Ubuntu, Raspberry Pi OS), Cockpit

Networking & Security: DNS (Pi-hole), Cloudflare DNS, TLS/SSL (Let's Encrypt wildcard certificates), Twingate zero-trust access, self-hosted RustDesk and Bitwarden, DHCP, port forwarding

Scripting & Web: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, C++ (entry level), YAML/Docker Compose, Bash

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Help Desk Specialist June 2022 – Present

National Vision Inc. – Lawrenceville, GA

- Resolve Tier 1 and Tier 2 hardware, software, and network issues for end users by phone, email, and remote access tools.
- Administer user accounts, groups, permissions, and device management in Active Directory, Office 365, and Intune.
- Manage and prioritize support cases in ServiceNow, keeping tickets documented and updated through resolution.
- Deploy, configure, and maintain Windows desktops, laptops, and printers, including onboarding/offboarding hardware setup and account provisioning.
- Write knowledge base articles and support procedures to speed up resolution and reduce repeat tickets.

Student Employee, IT Help Aug 2019 – Feb 2020

Veteran's Resource Center, Mt. San Jacinto College

- Troubleshot student laptops and academic technology issues, including slow performance, blue screen errors, and file management, by phone and in person.

HOME LAB PROJECTS

Multi-node self-hosted lab on a custom domain, documented at themagicalforest.net.

- **Zero-Trust Remote Access:** Deployed Twingate across multiple lab hosts so management interfaces (Portainer, Pi-hole) are reachable remotely without exposing admin ports to the public internet.
- **Reverse Proxy & Wildcard TLS:** Run Nginx Proxy Manager with Cloudflare DNS-01 validation to issue and renew a Let's Encrypt wildcard certificate without opening port 80 for validation.
- **Network-Wide DNS Filtering:** Host Pi-hole on a dedicated Raspberry Pi serving DNS for the whole network (~270K blocked domains); monitored with Cockpit and tuned idle CPU from ~98% to ~15%.
- **Troubleshooting Example:** Diagnosed a UDP port 53 conflict caused by the Windows Hyper-V Default Switch (ICS) that blocked Pi-hole on WSL2, then migrated the service to dedicated hardware and updated DHCP and proxy configuration.
- **Remote Access & Credential Management:** Self-host RustDesk for remote desktop access and Bitwarden for password management.
- **Containers & Hosting:** Manage Docker workloads with Portainer across hosts, including a port-forwarded Palworld game server; built and host a portfolio site on GitHub Pages behind Cloudflare.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Associate's Degree, Computer Science – Mt. San Jacinto College

CompTIA A+ – Exam scheduled Feb 2027

CompTIA Network+ – Next certification goal

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

GSA / Cashier – Super Target July 2018 – Sept 2020

- Led front-end operations and trained new team members in a high-volume environment.